

Guide 04: Disciplinary Pedagogy & Research Evidence

Part I: Foundational Pillars — Counsell, Quigley, The Writing Revolution & Cognitive Load

Academic Rationale: Every element of The History Revision Hub is grounded in contemporary educational research. We combine **disciplinary historical rigor** with **cognitive science** to support all learners from low-attaining SEND pupils to high-tariff GCSE candidates.

 **1. CHRISTINE COUNSELL: DISCIPLINARY NARRATIVE & ENQUIRY**

Core Concept: History is not a list of isolated facts; it is an enquiry-driven discipline where substantive narrative carries disciplinary meaning.

Application in Our System:

- **4-Act Dramatic Structure:** Context → Conflict → Archival Evidence → Historical Verdict.
- **Death of the Comprehension Treadmill:** Eliminates fragmented mid-text recall trivia; channels cognitive energy into a single high-yield Act 4 extended writing enquiry with PEEL scaffolds.
- **Pure [Act.Paragraph] Notation:** Eliminates sentence clutter, indexing text as [1.1], [2.1] to train pupils to cite narrative blocks.
- **Fingertip vs. Residual Knowledge:** Starter retrieval primes prior schema; front-loaded vocab fuels today's debate.

Key Reference: Counsell, C. (2000). "Historical knowledge and the curriculum", Teaching History, 100 • Dawson, I. (2004). "Creating a sense of enquiry", TH 117.

Research Link: www.history.org.uk (Historical Association)

 **2. ALEX QUIGLEY: CLOSING THE VOCABULARY GAP**

Core Concept: Academic language is the primary gatekeeper of student success. Explicit Tier-2/3 vocabulary instruction closes attainment disparities.

Application in Our System:

- **The Golden Sentence:** Pupils connect Tier-3 terms using subordinating conjunctions (*although, because, consequently*).
- **Odd-One-Out Trios:** Develops conceptual clustering and historiographical reasoning.
- **Immediate Margin Glossaries:** Prevents cognitive disruption by defining words right beside the text.

Key Reference: Quigley, A. (2018). *Closing the Vocabulary Gap*, Routledge.

Research Link: www.theconfidentteacher.co.uk (Research Blog)

 **3. THE WRITING REVOLUTION (HOCHMAN & WEXLER)**

Core Concept: Students cannot write rigorous multi-page essays until they master sentence-level syntax and causal relationships.

Application in Our System:

- **Because / But / So Scaffolding:** Structured analytical expansions before extended writing.
- **Evidence Stems & Counter-Stems:** Pre-crafted sentence openers that lower working memory barriers for SEND pupils.
- **Strict Model Answers:** Every task includes a historically accurate, high-tariff model answer.

Key Reference: Hochman, J. & Wexler, N. (2017). *The Writing Revolution*, Jossey-Bass.

Research Link: www.thewritingrevolution.org (TWR Institute)

 **4. SWELLER: COGNITIVE LOAD THEORY & SEND MEASURE**

Core Concept: Working memory is severely limited. Extraneous cognitive load must be minimized to allow germane schema construction.

Application in Our System:

- **2-Column Reading Measure:** Constrains line length to 50–65 characters, eliminating "eye-sweep tracking fatigue" for dyslexic readers.
- **Margin Line Numbering:** "Line 14, Johnny" rule allows instant teacher signposting without confusion.
- **Prior-Recall Isolation:** Do-Now retrieval strictly tests prior lessons, never current unfamiliar material.

Key Reference: Sweller, J. (1988). *Cognitive Load During Problem Solving*, Cognitive Science.

Research Link: educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk (EEF Review)

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Part II: Classroom Execution — SEND Inclusive Strategies, Rosenshine & Formative Ledgers

 5. SEND & INCLUSIVE ACCESSIBILITY IN HISTORY

Core Concept: High structure, not diluted content, creates accessibility for neurodiverse learners.

What Fails (Strictly Prohibited):

- ✗ Unchunked dense walls of text (causes tracking breakdown).
- ✗ Sentence-by-sentence indices [1.1], [1.2] (visual noise).
- ✗ Answering questions on page 9 while text is on page 2.

What Works (Enforced Across Revision Hub):

- ✓ 50–65 char measure + margin line numbers every 5 lines.
- ✓ 7.2mm pre-printed handwriting lines for motor control.
- ✓ Pre-crafted sentence openers and structure strips.
- ✓ Synchronized audio read-aloud for dual sensory input.

Reference: EEF (2020). *Special Educational Needs in Mainstream Schools*.

Research Link:
educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk/education-evidence/guidance-reports/send

 6. ROSENSHINE: PRIOR-RECALL & HINGE QUESTIONS

Core Concept: Daily retrieval practice automates recall and frees working memory for high-level enquiry.

Application in Our System:

- **Recall Isolation:** "Do Now" questions test prior units ONLY. Guessing unfamiliar content is banned.
- **Targeted Hinge Questions:** Embedded in teacher notes to verify conceptual mastery before transitions.
- **Small-Step Guided Practice:** Direct instruction chunked into manageable cognitive steps.

Reference: Rosenshine, B. (2012). *"Principles of instruction"*, American Educator.

Research Link: www.aft.org/ae/spring2012/rosenshine (Full Paper)

 7. DYLAN WILIAM: FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT & DIRT

Core Concept: Feedback must cause more work for the pupil than for the teacher.

Application in Our System:

- **Back-Cover Progress Ledger:** Formative breakdown of enquiry marks (/26) with benchmark conversion.
- **WWW / EBI Handwriting Lines:** Targeted feedback boxes with dedicated pupil DIRT response time.
- **Live Highlighting:** In-class yellow highlighter targeting academic vocabulary over red margin ink.

Reference: Wiliam, D. (2011). *Embedded Formative Assessment*.

Research Link:
educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk (EEF Feedback Report)

 8. MASTER EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH DIRECTORY

Direct Research Web Hubs for Department Leaders:

- **Historical Association:** www.history.org.uk
- **The Confident Teacher:** www.theconfidentteacher.co.uk
- **The Writing Revolution:** www.thewritingrevolution.org
- **EEF Guidance Reports:** educationendowmentfoundation.org.uk
- **British Dyslexia Association:** www.bdadyslexia.org.uk
- **Dylan Wiliam Assessment:** www.dylanwiliam.org

All platform documents are 100% compliant with UK national curriculum specifications and peer-reviewed educational research.